

SLATE LANE DISPATCH

CARRIER-DISPATCHER AGREEMENT & LIMITED AGENCY AUTHORIZATION

Version 1.0 - September 2026 | Fillable PDF | Designed for U.S. interstate property-carrier dispatch relationships

Important: This template is designed around current FMCSA guidance on dispatch services and bona fide agents. It is not a substitute for legal advice. The parties should obtain transportation-law counsel for their specific facts, state-law requirements, tax treatment, and dispute provisions.

1. Parties and Effective Terms

Dispatcher legal entity / individual

DBA / trade name

Dispatcher email

Dispatcher phone / WhatsApp

Carrier legal name (match FMCSA/W-9)

Carrier DBA (if any)

USDOT #

MC/MX #

Effective date

The motor carrier identified above ("**Carrier**") appoints the dispatcher identified above ("**Dispatcher**") as Carrier's limited dispatch and administrative agent, subject to the controls, restrictions, and carrier-specific instructions in this Agreement. Carrier remains the authorized motor carrier, retains final control of its operations, and may accept or reject any load without penalty.

2. Regulatory Intent and Agency Relationship

The parties intend this relationship to operate as a carrier-controlled dispatch arrangement and, to the extent applicable, within the framework for a bona fide agent described in 49 CFR 371.2(b) and FMCSA's final guidance on dispatch services. Status under federal law depends on actual conduct, not labels in a contract.

- **Carrier-specific representation.** Dispatcher acts for Carrier, not for shippers, and will disclose that it is acting as Carrier's dispatcher/agent when communicating with brokers or 3PLs.
- **No shipper solicitation.** Dispatcher will not negotiate freight directly with a shipper or shipper representative unless Dispatcher separately holds any authority legally required for that activity.
- **No freight-money intermediary.** Broker, shipper, or factoring payments for transportation will be made directly to Carrier or Carrier's factor. Dispatcher will not receive, hold, redirect, or disburse carrier freight proceeds.
- **No re-brokering or reassignment.** Dispatcher will not accept freight without identifying the Carrier and its available equipment, will not take a load first and then search the carrier market, and will not reassign a booked load to another motor carrier.
- **No traffic allocation discretion.** If Dispatcher serves multiple carriers, it will source and negotiate loads under each carrier's specific equipment, location, lane, availability, and written dispatch parameters and will not allocate an already-accepted shipment among competing carrier clients.
- **Carrier control.** Carrier has final authority over rates, lanes, equipment, drivers, pickup/delivery feasibility, hours of service, safety, and whether to accept any shipment.

3. Authorized Services

Subject to Carrier approval and instructions, Dispatcher may provide the following services:

- ☒ Search load boards and broker sources for carrier-specific opportunities
- ☒ Communicate and negotiate rates with licensed brokers/3PLs for Carrier
- ☒ Complete broker setup forms using Carrier-provided credentials and documents
- ☒ Receive and transmit rate confirmations and dispatch information
- ☒ Coordinate appointment/check-call information and routine load communications

- ☒ Organize BOL/POD, lumper, detention, TONU and other load documentation
- ☒ Assist Carrier with invoicing/document submission, without receiving freight funds
- ☒ Use Carrier-authorized load-board access strictly for Carrier's operations

Excluded unless separately agreed in writing: legal, tax, accounting, safety-management, driver qualification, drug/alcohol compliance, IFTA/IRP filings, insurance procurement, cargo claims adjustment, collections, factoring, brokerage, or guaranteeing payment by any broker.

4. Carrier Approval and Limited Signing Authority

Dispatcher may negotiate a proposed load, but Carrier approval is required before the Carrier is bound. Approval may be given by phone, text, messaging app, email, or CRM confirmation from an authorized Carrier contact.

- ☐ Carrier authorizes Dispatcher to sign/acknowledge broker rate confirmations on Carrier's behalf only after Carrier has approved the specific load.
- ☐ Carrier authorizes Dispatcher to complete and electronically sign broker setup forms only where the broker permits an authorized carrier agent to do so.
- ☐ The parties agree this is a limited agency authorization only and is not a general power of attorney.

Dispatcher may not open bank accounts, change Carrier's FMCSA registration, change insurance, borrow money, endorse checks, assign receivables, transfer operating authority, or make safety/driver decisions for Carrier.

5. Carrier Responsibilities

- Maintain active and appropriate operating authority, USDOT registration, process-agent filings, UCR and other registrations applicable to Carrier's operations.
- Maintain insurance required by law and by each broker/load, and promptly notify Dispatcher of cancellation, lapse, restriction, claim-related limitation, or material change.
- Operate safely and lawfully; maintain qualified drivers, equipment, ELD/HOS compliance, permits and cargo-specific qualifications.
- Provide accurate current credentials and notify Dispatcher promptly of changes to legal name, address, phone, email, ownership, factoring, authority, insurance or payment instructions.
- Review rate confirmations and immediately disclose conflicts between negotiated terms and the written rate confirmation.
- Provide POD/BOL and accessorial receipts promptly after delivery and preserve original documents when required.
- Never request or authorize Dispatcher to double broker, re-broker, impersonate another carrier, alter documents deceptively, or misstate equipment/driver/location information.

6. Dispatch Profile - Required Carrier-Specific Parameters

Equipment / trailer types

Truck unit(s) / count

Home base city/state

Preferred lanes / regions

States/regions to avoid

Maximum deadhead miles

Target / minimum loaded RPM

Minimum acceptable load rate

Commodity / load restrictions

Home-time requirements

Special dispatch instructions / fixed geographic or equipment allocation rules

These parameters are operational controls, not guarantees. Carrier may change them prospectively by written message. Dispatcher must not accept a load that materially conflicts with current Carrier instructions without specific approval.

7. Compensation and Billing

Select one primary fee structure. Only one should apply unless a written addendum states otherwise.

☐ Percentage fee: ____ % of the agreed fee basis below.

☐ Flat fee: \$_____ per completed load.

☐ Weekly flat fee: \$_____ per truck per week.

Percentage fee basis (if used):

☒ Linehaul only (recommended default); exclude fuel surcharge and pass-through reimbursements.

☐ Include negotiated accessorial revenue such as detention/layover/TONU, but exclude reimbursements such as lumpers.

Invoice frequency

Payment due

Late charge (optional; subject to law)

Fee earned when

Carrier payment method to Dispatcher

Dispatcher's compensation is paid **only by Carrier** under this Agreement. Dispatcher will not deduct its fee from broker/factoring freight proceeds or instruct a broker/factor to pay Dispatcher from Carrier's transportation receivable.

8. Broker Selection, Credit, and Nonpayment

Dispatcher will use commercially reasonable efforts to work with brokers that appear authorized and acceptable under Carrier's stated criteria. Carrier retains final approval of each broker and load. Unless Dispatcher expressly guarantees payment in a separate written agreement, Dispatcher does not guarantee a broker's solvency, creditworthiness, claims conduct, or payment. Carrier may require its factoring company to approve a broker before acceptance.

☐ Carrier requires factoring-company broker approval before any load is booked.

Factoring company / approval contact (if applicable)

9. Insurance, Liability, Claims, and Indemnity

Carrier is solely responsible for motor-carrier operations, including vehicle operation, cargo custody, cargo claims, driver conduct, safety, permits, regulatory compliance, bodily injury/property damage, and motor-carrier insurance. Dispatcher does not take possession of freight and is not the transporting carrier.

Each party is responsible for its own negligence, willful misconduct, fraud, breach of this Agreement, and violations of law. Carrier will defend and indemnify Dispatcher from third-party claims arising from transportation operations, cargo loss/damage, bodily injury, property damage, driver/equipment conduct, or Carrier regulatory violations, except to the extent caused by Dispatcher's own negligence, willful misconduct, fraud, or unauthorized acts. Dispatcher will indemnify Carrier for direct third-party claims to the extent caused by Dispatcher's own gross negligence, willful misconduct, fraud, or actions outside the authority granted by Carrier.

Neither party is liable to the other for special, incidental, punitive, or consequential damages except to the extent such limitation is prohibited by law or such damages arise from fraud, willful misconduct, confidentiality/data misuse, or indemnified third-party claims.

10. Confidentiality, Credentials, and Data Security

Each party will protect nonpublic business information, broker credentials, load-board credentials, rate information, customer/broker contacts, tax/payment documents, and personal data. Dispatcher may store Carrier documents in SlateLane's CRM and use them only for authorized dispatch, broker setup, compliance verification, recordkeeping, and related administrative purposes.

☐ Carrier authorizes secure storage and use of its onboarding documents and broker/load-board credentials for the services described in this Agreement. Carrier should not send passwords by ordinary email when a secure credential-sharing method is available. Sensitive tax identifiers should remain on the official tax form rather than being duplicated across operational documents.

11. Term, Suspension, and Termination

Initial term

Month-to-month

Ordinary termination notice

7 days written notice

Either party may terminate according to the notice period above. Dispatcher may suspend services immediately for inactive/revoked authority, insurance lapse, suspected fraud, unsafe/unlawful instructions, repeated nonpayment, credential misuse, or conduct that could constitute unauthorized brokerage. Carrier remains responsible for earned fees on loads booked before termination. Upon termination, Dispatcher will stop using Carrier credentials and, subject to lawful retention obligations, archive or delete access credentials.

12. Independent Contractor; Taxes

Dispatcher is an independent contractor and limited agent only for the authorized dispatch functions stated here. Nothing creates a partnership, joint venture, employment relationship, freight brokerage relationship, or ownership interest. Each party is responsible for its own taxes. Dispatcher will provide the tax documentation appropriate to its status (for example, Form W-9 if a U.S. person/entity or the applicable Form W-8 if foreign), and Carrier may report payments as required by law.

13. Records, Electronic Signatures, and Notices

The parties consent to electronic records and electronic signatures. A typed name, drawn signature, accepted e-signature, or other electronic process adopted with intent to sign may be used. Electronic copies and counterparts may be treated as originals to the extent permitted by applicable law. The parties should retain a complete executed PDF and related amendments in a form capable of accurate reproduction.

Carrier notice email

Dispatcher notice email

Governing law / state (fill before signing)

Venue / county-state (optional)

14. Entire Agreement; Changes; Severability

This Agreement, together with any signed schedules/addenda, is the complete agreement for the dispatch relationship and supersedes prior inconsistent communications. Changes to fees, authority, scope, or material obligations must be in writing or recorded electronically and accepted by both parties. If a provision is unenforceable, the remaining provisions continue to the extent allowed by law. No waiver is continuing unless stated in writing.

15. Signatures

☐ Carrier signer intends to sign electronically and certifies authority to bind Carrier.

Carrier authorized signer - printed name

Title

Carrier signature / typed legal name

Date

Optional drawn Carrier signature

Use your PDF viewer's Fill & Sign tool, draw a signature, or type your signature in the field below.

☐ Dispatcher signer intends to sign electronically and certifies authority to bind Dispatcher.

Dispatcher authorized signer - printed name

Title

Dispatcher signature / typed legal name

Date

Optional drawn Dispatcher signature

Use your PDF viewer's Fill & Sign tool, draw a signature, or type your signature in the field below.

Schedule A - Carrier Dispatch Profile and Allocation Controls

Complete this schedule for each carrier relationship. The purpose is to document the specific lanes, equipment, availability and instructions under which Dispatcher sources loads for this Carrier. It helps keep dispatch activity carrier-specific rather than accepting freight first and allocating it later.

Truck / unit identifier

Driver name / preferred contact

Equipment / dimensions

Max legal payload / special capability

Normal origin / operating region

Preferred destination / lanes

Minimum rate / RPM target

Maximum deadhead

Typical availability / home-time

Restricted commodities / regions

Specific non-overlap rule if Dispatcher serves similar carriers (geographic, equipment, dedicated truck, or other carrier-specific criteria)

☐ Carrier confirms Dispatcher must identify this Carrier and available equipment before accepting/booking any shipment.

☐ Carrier confirms a shipment booked for Carrier may not be reassigned by Dispatcher to another motor carrier.

Carrier initials: _____ Dispatcher initials: _____ Date: _____